



▲ LIMESTONE PINNACLES AT GUNUNG MULU NATIONAL PARK

The Pearl River

Location Guangdong and Guangxi provinces, southern China

This name usually encompasses the three great rivers of Guangdong—the Xi, Bei, and Dong—that share a common delta. Measured from the source of the longest of these (the Xi) to the South China Sea, the Pearl River is the third longest in China at 1,365 miles (2,197 km). Its basin covers an area of 158,300 square miles (410,000 square km). The river is named after the pearl-colored shells found on its bed in Guangzhou.

Puerto Princesa Subterranean River National Park

Location The western coast of Palawan, Philippines

The most extraordinary feature of this World Heritage Site is its underground river, which is 5 miles (8 km) long, discharges directly into the South China Sea, and is tidal in its lower reaches. Underground chambers, waterfalls, stalactites, and stalagmites are other features of the cave system. Measured by volume, the 1,200-ft (360-m) Italian's Chamber is one of the largest in the world.

Gunung Mulu

Location Sarawak, Borneo

Located beneath the rain forests of the Gunung Mulu National Park, everything about this cave system is on a massive scale. It contains the Sarawak Chamber, which at 2,000 ft (600 m) long, 1,360 ft (415 m) wide, and 260 ft (80 m) high is the largest on Earth. Gunung Mulu has a total of 183 miles (295 km) of explored caves, including Clearwater Cave,